Confidential

Robert Fearey
robert fearey@bt com

611691734
Timothy Robinson
Timothy.3.robinson@bt com

26th October 2021

Dear Timothy,

The outcome

Following your grievance meeting held on 16/09/2021 where you were accompanied by your CWU represenatative, I'm writing to let you know the outcome of your grievance.

Conclusion

Having considered all the information available to me, I don't uphold your grievance.

Following a thorough investigation, I have found no evidence to uphold the alleged breach of BT policies relating to career progression, although areas of learning have been identified for you.

I do not believe that anyone outlined in the grievance has acted in an unprofessional manner and have in fact acted in a manner to try and help steer you in the right direction. Whilst strong performance in your current role this unfortunately does not guarantee career progression

You need to consider the approach you are making to your career progression as ultimately it is your responsibility to drive your own career and identify suitable opportunities within BT Group.

Once I had absorbed the details of the case, I approached the CWU week commencing 27th October with what I thought was a suitable outcome and offered to be a mentor for you. The CWU agreed that this was a good outcome and approached you. You refused this offer and asked for the grievance to be completed with me contacting the witnesses

To assist in your understanding of my decision I have attached my conclusions and recommendations. I hope that you'll see from my response that I've thoroughly investigated and taken time considering each issue/point you raised.

Whilst I haven't upheld your grievance I've carefully considered all the information available to me and taken each issue/point you have raised seriously and drawn appropriate conclusions as a result.

As a business we want to ensure that all employees are treated according to our values and appropriate action has been taken in order to resolve your grievance

What happens next?

I have looked at all aspects of the case and made recommendations where I feel appropriate for the parties involved in the case. Below are the recommendations that are directly applicable to you. I am not at liberty to share with you the recommendations relating to other individuals as they remain confidential to those involved.

AP1 To proactively seek and apply for jobs via the BT job vacancies recruitment portal: Recruitment (bt.com)
AP2 Investigate and observe different working areas by investigating via the BT intranet to establish areas of possible career progression
AP3 Identify 2 to 3 key working areas/job types for the future and identify key skills required
AP4 Fill development gaps using all tools available i.e., LinkedIn learning, Learning Home, buddying, external courses, and shadowing.
AP5 Seek a formal career mentor via the following link: Mentorship Hub (bt.com)
AP6 Create bespoke CVs for each job applied for ensuring 5 key skills are covered
AP7 Send in application to be a mock candidate in the interviewing skills course
AP8 Build a large networking group
AP9 Take time to familiarisers with the HR recruitment policy and processes
AP10 Observe HR interviewing techniques homepage

You do have the right to appeal against any part of this outcome. If you decide to do that, you should put your grounds for appeal in writing to Lucy Profeta lucy.profeta@bt.com. Your appeal should say what it is about the outcome that you disagree with and why. They need to have it within seven calendar days of you getting this letter. So make sure they've got it by 4/11/21.

Confidentiality

As you are already aware the grievance procedure is confidential and this letter must be treated as confidential, to protect information relating to others involved in this investigation. You must not divulge this information to anyone within BT, other than your union representative or company 'friend'. Any breach of this confidentiality will be treated seriously.

Getting extra help

If you feel you may benefit from counselling or support, we provide access to a confidential Employee Assistance Programme (EAP), which provides up to 4 face to face counselling sessions or a telephone counselling service. In addition, the programme also provides an information service on issues relating to welfare rights, finance, debt management and legal matters (not employment law). The service is available for employees 24/7 and can be accessed via 0800 917 6767. Further information on the service can be found at https://hr.bt.com/en-gb/safety-wellbeing/support-services/employee-assistance/employee-assistance-programme .

Yours sincerely,

Robert Fearey – Ethernet Delivery Manager
Enc. Key areas investigated

KEY AREAS INVESTIGATED

After listening to Timothy's grievance, I decided to approach the key people outlined in his grievance. I did not approach all the people named in the grievance only those at the relevant stage i e people speaking directly to Timothy.

In May 2019, during his first year being the top revenue earner word of his performance reached Director level and he received an email from Claire Harris thanking him for his outstanding contribution towards revenue generation for the company. Timothy responded to Claire's e-mail regarding career advice and Claire directed him to Alex Dawson and Alex put Timothy in touch with Darren Hudson who runs the BTNET team in Sheffield.

Darren Hudson response:
Darren said after some time for consideration he recalled the interview he had with Timothy Darren said that sadly Timothy had not passed the interview and the role had been offered to another interviewee Darren said, that whilst he couldn't remember the interview in detail, he recalled that the interview had been difficult as Timothy did not give good examples against the questions posed that showed on this occasion that Timothy lacked the desired skills for the role.

Darren also felt that the timeframe quoted by Timothy seemed wrong as Darren said he had not worked directly to Alex for several years Darren did say the interview had been completed with Alex Dawson and they both agreed that the interview was a failure based on experience (sales/product knowledge) and importantly the quality of the interview and preparation. Darren did confirm that Timothy had spent time at the Sheffield office prior to the interview as arranged by Darren

Joel Skillington response:
Joel said, he had been covering manager for Timothy approximately 3 years ago. Joel said he felt he had a good working relationship with Timothy and has limited contact these days. Joel said that he felt he had been very supportive to Timothy whilst he had been covering manager

Joel said, Timothy's overall performance had been good, and he had to have some occasional local discussions on performance. Joel said, Timothy had a very strong emphasis on lead to sales (L2S) but in fairness was very good at this element of the job Joel said he was disappointed that Timothy had perceived his comments on his CV and covering letter as detrimental as he had taken time out of his schedule to advise Timothy on what he felt were fair and constructive comments to enhance his CV

Joel also said he wasn't aware of anyone in the office who would be pleased to see Timothy fail at interviews. Joel said, he had not seen any evidence of this on site

Joel did say that Timothy was highly geared towards L2S and had limited discussion with himself relating to a move to a leadership role. Joel said, Timothy and he had sat next to one and other in the office and would describe their relationship as good. Joel did not on any occasion say to Timothy that job applications should be sent via himself

Julian Capuano response:
Timothy applied for role (134541 - Sales Account Manager) in January 2020 He said he made multiple attempts to discuss the role with Julian Capuano however he never responded Julian is no longer with BT so unable to investigate this point further.

Daniel Finnegan response:
Timothy wrote a letter to Philip Jansen CEO in his monthly Q+A session and asked him to review his performance and career progress Emily Colvin from HR then responded to Timothy and they discussed his situation From that discussion Timothy applied for a Commercial Professional post (151032) Timothy heard nothing back despite repeated attempts.

Daniel said regarding the commercial role that Timothy missed the job advert deadline That said, Daniel did have a conversation with Timothy and Daniel quickly ascertained that Timothy did not have the core skills required for the role namely data analysis and reporting

DECISION

Following a thorough investigation, I have found no evidence to uphold the alleged breach of BT policies relating to career progression, although areas of learning have been identified for Timothy Robinson.

I do not believe that anyone outlined in the grievance has acted in an unprofessional manner and have in fact acted in a manner to try and help steer Timothy in the right direction Whilst strong performance in his current role this unfortunately does not guarantee career progression

Timothy needs to consider the approach he is making to his career progression as ultimately it is Timothy's responsibility to drive his own career and identify suitable opportunities within BT Group

Once I had absorbed the details of the case, I approached the CWU week commencing 27th October with what I thought was a suitable outcome and offered to be a mentor for Timothy. The CWU agreed that this was a good outcome and approached Timothy Timothy refused this offer and asked for the grievance to be completed with me contacting the witnesses

I have therefore recommended that the following remedial actions take place to address the learning identified.

REMEDIAL ACTION / POINTS OF LEARNING

Action Point	Detail	Name who this action applies to	Owner	Completion date
AP1	To proactively seek and apply for jobs via the BT job vacancies recruitment portal Recruitment (bt com)	Timothy Robinson	Timothy Robinson	Q3/4
AP2	Investigate and observe different working areas by investigating via the BT intranet to establish areas of possible career progression	Timothy Robinson	Timothy Robinson	Q3/4
AP3	Identify 2 to 3 key working areas/job types for the future and identify key skills required	Timothy Robinson	Timothy Robinson	Q3/4
AP4	Fill development gaps using all tools available i.e , LinkedIn learning, Learning Home, buddying, external courses, and shadowing	Timothy Robinson	Timothy Robinson	Q3/4
AP5	Seek a formal career mentor via the following link Mentorship Hub (bt com)	Timothy Robinson	Timothy Robinson	October/November 2021
AP6	Create bespoke CVs for each job applied for ensuring 5 key skills are covered	Timothy Robinson	Timothy Robinson	Q3/4
AP7	Send in application to be a mock candidate in the interviewing skills course	Timothy Robinson	Timothy Robinson	Q3/4
AP8	Build a large networking group	Timothy Robinson	Timothy Robinson	Q3/4
AP9	Take time to familiarisers with the HR recruitment policy and processes	Timothy Robinson	Timothy Robinson	Q3/4
AP10	Observe HR interviewing techniques homepage	Timothy Robinson	Timothy Robinson	Q3/4